

FINISH

1. Passage anchor

> “She gave it to me right after I **finished** an important set of final exams...”

Passage meaning

finish = complete something that you have been doing

完成；**做完**

Here:

> **finish an exam**

= **完成考試**；**做完考卷**

Practice

1. I **finished** the exam just before time was called.

我在時間結束前剛好**做完考試**。

2. She **finished** her homework before dinner.

她在晚飯前**完成了功課**。

Core meanings of FINISH

2. finish — complete an activity or task

= bring an activity, piece of work, or process to an end

完成；**做完**

This is the exact passage sense.

Examples

1. I need to **finish** this report tonight.

我今晚需要**完成這份報告**。

2. She **finished** the project ahead of schedule.

她提早**完成了專案**。

3. finish doing something

= complete an activity expressed by an -ing form

****做完某事****

Examples

1. I ****finished reading**** the book yesterday.

我昨天****看完了那本書****。

2. He ****finished writing**** the email.

他****寫完了那封電郵****。

Important pattern:

> finish doing

> not normally

> finish to do

Reach the end of something

4. finish — reach the end of a period, course, journey, etc.

= come to the end of something

****結束；完成****

Examples

1. The class ****finishes**** at four.

課堂四點****結束****。

2. She ****finished university**** last year.

她去年****完成大學學業 / 大學畢業****。

5. finish school / university / a course

= complete a period of education or training

****完成學業；畢業；完成課程****

Examples

1. He ****finished school**** at eighteen.

他十八歲時**完成中學學業**。

2. She **finished a training course** in June.

她六月**完成了一個培訓課程**。

Consume all of something

6. finish — eat or drink all of something

= consume all the food or drink

吃完；喝完

Examples

1. Please **finish your dinner**.

請把晚餐**吃完**。

2. He **finished the bottle of water**.

他把那瓶水**喝完了**。

This is a common everyday extension of “bring to an end.”

Use all of something

7. finish — use the whole amount

= use everything that remains of something

用完；耗盡

Examples

1. We **finished the milk** this morning.

我們今早把牛奶**用完 / 喝完了**。

2. She **finished the last of the paint**.

她把最後那點油漆**用完了**。

End / conclude

8. finish — end

= stop or come to an end

****結束；終止****

Examples

1. The meeting ****finished**** at noon.

會議在中午****結束****。

2. The film ****finished**** later than expected.

電影比預期更晚****結束****。

Here, ****finish**** can be intransitive.

Final part of a performance or event

9. finish — ending / final part

As a noun:

= the final part or ending of something

****結尾；終場；最後部分****

Examples

1. The race had an exciting ****finish****.

那場比賽有一個刺激的****結局 / 終點衝刺****。

2. The film builds toward a dramatic ****finish****.

這部電影逐漸走向戲劇性的****結尾****。

Sports / competition result

10. finish — final position in a competition

= the position in which someone ends a race or competition

****最終名次；完賽名次****

Examples

1. She achieved a second-place ****finish****.

她取得了****第二名的成績****。

2. It was his best **finish** of the season.

那是他本季最佳的**最終名次**。

11. finish first / second / last

= end a race or competition in a particular position

以第.....名完成比賽

Examples

1. He **finished first** in the race.

他以**第一名完成比賽**。

2. The team **finished third** overall.

球隊最終排名**第三**。

Kill / defeat decisively

12. finish someone/something off

= complete the destruction, defeat, or killing of someone/something

徹底擊敗；解決掉；殺死

Examples

1. The final goal **finished the match off**.

最後一球**徹底鎖定了勝局**。

2. The injury nearly **finished his career off**.

那次受傷幾乎**毀掉了他的職業生涯**。

This is figurative and stronger than ordinary **finish**.

13. finish someone

Informal/context-dependent:

= kill, defeat completely, or ruin someone

幹掉；徹底擊敗；毀掉

Examples

1. One more mistake could **finish him** professionally.
再犯一次錯，可能會在職業上**徹底毀掉他**。
2. The boxer tried to **finish his opponent** in the final round.
那名拳手試圖在最後一回合**徹底擊倒對手**。

This meaning depends heavily on context.

Surface / appearance

14. finish — final surface treatment

As a noun:

= final coating, texture, polish, or appearance of a surface

表面處理；塗層；質感

Examples

1. The table has a smooth **finish**.
這張桌子的表面有很平滑的**質感**。
2. The metal has a matte **finish**.
這種金屬是**啞面處理**。

This is a major distinct noun sense.

15. matte / glossy / polished finish

= type of final appearance on a surface

啞面 / 亮面 / 拋光表面

Examples

1. I prefer a **matte finish**.
我比較喜歡**啞面質感**。
2. The cabinet has a **glossy finish**.
這個櫃子表面是**亮面處理**。

Manufacturing / craftsmanship

16. finish — quality of final workmanship

= degree of care, smoothness, or refinement in how something has been completed

****做工；收尾品質****

Examples

1. The furniture has an excellent ****finish****.
這件家具的****做工 / 收尾****很好。
2. The product looks expensive because of its fine ****finish****.
這件產品因為****收尾精緻****而看起來很高級。

Verb: apply final treatment

17. finish a surface

= apply the final coating, polish, or treatment

****對表面作最後處理；上漆；拋光****

Examples

1. The wood was ****finished with oil****.
木材最後用油作了****表面處理****。
2. The metal was carefully ****finished**** by hand.
金屬表面由人手仔細****完成最後處理****。

Final touch / completion

18. finishing touch

= final small detail that completes or improves something

****最後點綴；最後修飾****

Examples

1. The flowers were the **finishing touch**.

那些花是**最後的點綴**。

2. A handwritten note added the **finishing touch** to the gift.

手寫便條為那份禮物加上了**最後的完美點綴**。

19. finishing touches

= final small improvements before something is complete

最後修飾；收尾工作

Examples

1. We are putting the **finishing touches** on the report.

我們正在為報告做**最後收尾**。

2. She added the **finishing touches** to the room.

她為房間加上**最後的修飾**。

Complete all food/drink

20. finish off food/drink

= consume the remaining amount completely

把剩下的吃完 / 喝完

Examples

1. He **finished off the cake**.

他把蛋糕**全部吃完了**。

2. She **finished off the coffee** before leaving.

她離開前把咖啡**喝光了**。

Related forms

21. finished — completed

= completed and no longer requiring work

完成的；做好的

Examples

1. The report is finally **finished**.
報告終於**完成了**。

2. Is the painting **finished**?
這幅畫**完成了嗎**？

22. finished — no longer useful / ruined

Informal:

= ruined, defeated, or unable to continue
完了；毀了；沒希望了

Examples

1. Without funding, the project is **finished**.
沒有資金的話，這個專案就**完了**。

2. If they lose this contract, the company could be **finished**.
如果失去這份合約，公司可能就**撐不下去了**。

23. unfinished

= not yet completed
未完成的

Examples

1. I still have some **unfinished work**.
我還有一些**未完成的工作**。

2. The building remained **unfinished** for years.
那棟建築多年來一直**沒有完工**。

24. finisher

= person or thing that finishes something; in sport, someone especially good at completing scoring

chances

****完成者；終結者****

Examples

1. He is a strong ****finisher**** in close races.
他在接近的比賽中是一名很強的****衝刺終結者****。
2. The striker is an excellent ****finisher****.
那名前鋒是一位出色的****門前終結者****。

Sports use is especially common.

High-value patterns

25. finish with something

= end by using, saying, or doing something

****以……作結；最後以……結束****

Examples

1. She ****finished with a short thank-you message****.
她最後以一段簡短的致謝****作結****。
2. The meal ****finished with dessert****.
這頓飯最後以甜品****結束****。

26. finish by doing something

= perform something as the final action

****最後以做某事結束****

Examples

1. He ****finished by thanking everyone****.
他最後以感謝大家****作結****。
2. She ****finished by asking one final question****.
她最後問了一個問題來****結束****。

27. finish up

= complete something or come to an end

****完成；收尾；結束****

Examples

1. I need ten minutes to ****finish up****.

我需要十分鐘來****收尾****。

2. The meeting ****finished up**** around six.

會議大約六點****結束****。

Informal.

Key contrasts

28. finish vs complete

****finish****

= reach the end of an activity or task

****完成；做完****

****complete****

= make something whole, fully done, or lacking nothing

****完成；使完整****

They overlap strongly, but:

> finish eating

> is natural

while:

> complete eating

> is usually unnatural.

29. finish vs end

****finish****

often focuses on completing an activity.

****end****

focuses more generally on something stopping.

Compare:

> I ****finished the report****.

> 我完成了報告。

> The meeting ****ended**** at five.

> 會議五點結束。

Both can sometimes work in intransitive contexts.

30. finish vs stop

****stop****

= cease doing something, whether completed or not

****停止****

****finish****

= reach completion

****完成****

Compare:

> I ****stopped writing****.

> 我停止寫了。(不一定寫完)

> I ****finished writing****.

> 我寫完了。

This distinction is very important.

31. finish vs graduate

****finish university****

= complete university studies

****完成大學學業****

****graduate****

= formally complete a course and receive qualification

****畢業****

They often overlap, but ****graduate**** specifically emphasizes successful completion.

32. finish vs surface

As nouns:

****finish****

= final texture/coating/appearance of a surface

****表面處理；質感****

****surface****

= outermost layer or exterior part itself

****表面****

Compare:

> a wooden ****surface****

> 木製表面

> a glossy ****finish****

> 亮面處理

Meaning map

The central concept of ****finish**** is:

****bring something to its endpoint****

From this develop:

Task

finish an exam

→ ****完成考試****

Activity

finish reading

→ ****讀完****

Food/drink

finish dinner

→ **吃完晚餐**

Event

the meeting finishes

→ **會議結束**

Competition

finish first

→ **以第一名完成**

Result

a strong finish

→ **強勁收尾 / 最終表現**

Destruction

finish someone off

→ **徹底擊敗 / 解決掉**

A separate noun branch develops from the idea of final completion:

Surface

matte finish

→ **啞面處理**

Craftsmanship

fine finish

→ **精緻收尾**

Final detail

finishing touch

→ **最後點綴**

The passage uses the straightforward completion sense:

> **finished an important set of final exams**

> → **完成了一組重要的期末考試**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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finish — complete a task/activity	把工作、活動或任務做到結束；完成 / 做完
finish doing something	把某項正在進行的活動做完
finish school/course/university	完成學業、課程或教育階段
finish — eat/drink all	把食物或飲料全部吃完 / 喝完
finish — use all	把某樣東西全部用完
finish — come to an end	活動、會議、電影等結束
finish — noun ending	某事物最後的部分、結尾或終場
finish — competition position	比賽結束時取得的最終名次
finish first/second/etc.	以第一、第二等名次完成比賽
finish someone off	徹底擊敗、毀掉或解決某人 / 某事
finish — surface treatment	物件表面的最後塗層、質感或處理
matte/glossy finish	啞面 / 亮面的表面處理
finish — workmanship	產品最後的做工、收尾品質
finish a surface	對表面作最後塗裝、拋光或處理
finishing touch	令某物完整或更好看的最後點綴
finishing touches	完成前最後的小修飾或收尾工作
finish off food/drink	把剩餘的食物或飲料全部吃完 / 喝完
finished — completed	已完成、做好的
finished — ruined	非正式：完了、沒希望了、被徹底擊敗
unfinished	尚未完成的
finisher	完成者；體育中善於完成得分機會的終結者
finish with	以某事作結
finish by doing	最後做某事來結束
finish up	收尾、完成、結束

Passage recap

> “...right after I **finished** an important set of final exams...”

Here:

finish = complete an activity or task

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **完成**

* **做完**

Natural contextual translation:

****她是在我完成一場 / 一系列重要的期末考試之後送給我的。 ****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****finish****

= ****to bring an activity, task, or piece of work to completion****

****完成 ; 做完****

The key contrast is:

> ****stop an exam/task****

> → 停止 , 不一定完成

> ****finish an exam/task****

> → 做到最後並完成

In the passage, the speaker had fully completed the exams before receiving the gift.